

EDUCATION

Harvard University
PhD in Psychology (2023 – present)
Advisor: Jesse Snedeker

Harvard University
MA in Psychology (2023 – 2025)
Advisor: Jesse Snedeker

University of Maryland, College Park
B.A. in Psychology and Criminology/Criminal Justice (2014 – 2018)
College Park Scholars Program
cum laude

PEER REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Waite, B., Yacovone, A., & Snedeker, J. (2025). Case Clozed: Young Children Can Explicitly Predict Upcoming Words in a Naturalistic, Story-based Cloze Task. *Journal of Child Language*, 1–25. doi:10.1017/S0305000925100251

Yacovone, A., **Waite, B.**, Levari, T., & Snedeker, J. (2024). Let them eat ceke: An electrophysiological study of form-based prediction in rich naturalistic contexts. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*. <https://doi.org/10.1037/xge0001677>

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION AND UNDER REVIEW

Waite, B., Levari, T., Yacovone, A., & Snedeker, J. (in preparation). The development of prediction during naturalistic listening: ERP evidence for improved top-down processing with age and language ability.

Yacovone, A., **Waite, B.**, & Snedeker, J. (in preparation). Prediction is a piece of ceke: An EEG study of form-based prediction in young children during storytelling contexts.

CONFERENCE TALKS

Waite, B., Yacovone, A., Levari, T., & Snedeker, J. (November 2025). *The development of prediction during naturalistic listening: ERP evidence for improved top-down processing with age and language ability*. Conference talk at 50th Boston University Conference on Language Development, Boston University, Boston, MA, USA.

INVITED TALKS

Waite, B., (May 12, 2025). *EEG as a window into developmental sentence processing*. NeuroCognition of Language Lab, Tufts University.

Waite, B., (March 7, 2025). *Lexical access during story listening across development*. Integrated Language Sciences & Technology (ILST) Seminar, University of Pennsylvania.

CONFERENCE POSTER PRESENTATIONS

Waite, B., Snedeker, J., & Yacovone, A. (*forthcoming*, November 2026). *It's about time: Moving beyond ERPs to study the development of language processing with multivariate temporal response functions*. Poster at 51st Boston University Conference on Language Development, Boston University, Boston, MA, USA.

Costello, K., Gomes, V., **Waite, B.**, & Snedeker, J. (*forthcoming*, November 2026). *Not so hard: Children produce appropriate sentence completions following negation*. Poster at 51st Boston University Conference on Language Development, Boston University, Boston, MA, USA.

Waite, B., Costello, K., Gomes, V., & Snedeker, J. (June 2026). *Not so hard: Children produce appropriate sentence completions following negation*. Poster at 4th Experiments in Linguistic Meaning Conference, University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia, PA, USA.

Levari, T., **Waite, B.**, & Snedeker, J. (November 2025). *Lexical prediction in children with and without autism during naturalistic listening*. Poster at 50th Boston University Conference on Language Development, Boston University, Boston, MA, USA.

Waite, B., Yacovone, A., Levari, T., & Snedeker, J. (September 2025). *The development of lexical access and linguistic prediction: Adapting story-based EEG tasks to understand comprehension in preschoolers*. Poster at 17th Annual Meeting of the Society for the Neurobiology of Language, Gallaudet University, Washington DC, USA.

Waite, B., Levari, T., Yacovone, A., & Snedeker, J. (March 2025). *Lexical access during naturalistic listening in middle childhood and early adolescence*. Poster at 38th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of Maryland, College Park, MD, USA.

Waite, B., Levari, T., Yacovone, A., & Snedeker, J. (November 2024). *Lexical access during naturalistic listening in middle childhood and early adolescence*. Poster at 49th Boston University Conference on Language Development, Boston University, Boston, MA, USA.

Yacovone, A., **Waite, B.**, & Snedeker, J. (March 2024). *Form-based prediction is a piece of ceke: Young children predict the form of upcoming words during natural storytelling contexts*. Poster at 37th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI, USA.

Levari, T., Larman, J., **Waite, B.**, & Snedeker, J. (March 2024). *Lexical Access during Naturalistic Listening in L1 and L2 Speakers of English*. Poster at 37th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI, USA.

Waite, B., Yacovone, A., & Snedeker, J. (November 2023). *Children make robust lexical predictions in a naturalistic context*. Poster at 48th Boston University Conference on Language Development, Boston University, Boston, MA, USA.

Waite, B., Yacovone, A., & Snedeker, J. (March 2023). *Children make robust lexical predictions in a naturalistic context*. Poster at 36th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of Pittsburgh, Pittsburgh, PA, USA.

Yacovone, A., **Waite, B.**, Levari, T., & Snedeker, J. (March 2022). *Let them eat ceke: an EEG study of form-based prediction in rich naturalistic contexts* [Conference presentation]. 35th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, UC Santa Cruz and virtual.

GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

<i>Feb 2025—present</i>	Rand Innovation Fund Amount awarded: \$6,000
<i>June 2024—Sep 2025</i>	Mind, Brain, and Behavior Interdisciplinary Reading Group Grant, Harvard University Amount awarded: \$800
<i>May 2024</i>	Stimson Fund Research Grant, Harvard University Amount awarded: \$1,000

AWARDS & HONORS

<i>2015—2018</i>	Dean's list, University of Maryland
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RESEARCH WORK EXPERIENCE

<i>Jul 2019—Jul 2023</i>	Lab Manager/Research Assistant	Snedeker Lab, Harvard University
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TEACHING

Harvard University, Psychology department
GRADUATE TEACHING ASSISTANT

<i>Fall 2026</i>	PSY 1: Introduction to Psychological Science, Instructor: Steve Pinker <i>Head Teaching Fellow</i>
<i>Spring 2026</i>	PSY 1900: Introduction to Statistics for the Behavioral Sciences, Instructor: Haley Keglovits
<i>Fall 2025</i>	PSY 1: Introduction to Psychological Science, Instructor: Dan Gilbert

University of Maryland, Psychology department
UNDERGRADUATE TEACHING ASSISTANT

<i>Spring 2018</i>	PSYC433: Basic Helping Skills: Research & Practice, Instructor: Jonathan Mohr
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MENTORSHIP

<i>Aug 26 – Present</i>	Concentration advisor, Winthrop and Dunster houses, Psychology Undergraduate Program, Harvard University		
<i>Research Assistants</i>	Jan 26 – May 26	Doanh Vu	Harvard College, Linguistics
	Jan 26 – Present	Sucheta Srikanth	Harvard College, Psychology
	Jan 26 – May 26	Alani Goins	Harvard College, Neuroscience
	Jan 26 – May 26	Angelina Chen	Harvard College, Psychology
	Sep 25 – May 26	Ozzie Okoro	Harvard College, Neuroscience
	Jan 25 – June 25	Samantha Fuchs	
	Sep 24 – Aug 25	Cathlyn Boyle	University of Bath, Psychology
	Jan 24 – Dec 24	Orne Akter	Harvard College, Neuroscience
	Jan 24 – May 24	Hannah Kleiner	University of Bath, Psychology
	Jan 24 – May 24	Amelia Harris	University of Bath, Psychology
<i>Thesis Students</i>	Sep 25 – Present	Imogen Phillips	University of Bath, Psychology
	Sep 24 – Present	Kimi Costello	University of Bath, Psychology
	Jan 23 – May 24	Jarom Larman	Harvard College, Neuroscience

	Sep 21 – May 23	Jenna Hughes	University of Bath, Psychology
<i>Summer Interns</i>	Summer 2025	Aaron Arlanza	Harvard College, Linguistics
	Summer 2024	Jesse McIlhenny	Pomona College, Linguistics
	Summer 2022	Ashley Winegarden	New York U, Psychology
	Summer 2022	Dorothy Levine	Oberlin College, Psychology
	Summer 2021	Praneetha Inampudi	University of Texas, Psychology

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT AND TRAINING

Summer 2026 UC-Davis/SDSU ERP Boot Camp: Selected participant in an intensive 10-day workshop on the ERP technique

TECHNICAL SKILLS

EEG/ERP: EEG setup and data collection (Brain Vision Recorder, ActiCHamp/ActiCHamp Plus)
 EEG data cleaning and processing (Matlab: eeglab/erplab)

Experiment creation: PCIBex, PsychoPy

Coding: R

DEPARTMENTAL/UNIVERSITY SERVICE

AY 2026–27 Graduate Student Representative, Committee on Undergraduate Instruction, Psychology Department, Harvard University

Aug 2025–present Harvard Language and Cognition Seminar organizer

Aug–Oct 2025 Havard PPREP program coordinator

AY 2024–25 PsyMentor program coordinator: Created small groups of trainees within the psychology department to increase peer support and community

OTHER SERVICE

Apr 2024–present Event organizer and group founder: Experimental Pragmatics and Semantics reading group (participants from Havard Psychology, Harvard Linguistics, Harvard Graduate School of Education, MIT Brain and Cognitive Sciences, MIT Philosophy, Tufts Psychology)

<i>June 2024–present</i>	Event organizer: EEG reading group
<i>Nov 2022, 23, 24, 25</i>	Volunteer at the 47 th , 48 th , 49 th , and 50 th Boston University Conferences on Language Development (BUCLD)
<i>2021–2023</i>	Fellowship of Research Staff at Harvard (FRESH) group coordinator